



What is Amazon Inspector?

Amazon Inspector is an **automated vulnerability management** and **software assessment** service that helps improve the security and compliance of your AWS workloads.

It scans:

- **Amazon EC2 instances**
 - **ECR container images**
 - **Lambda functions**
 - For **software vulnerabilities** (CVEs), **network exposure**, and **deviation from security best practices**.
-



Key Benefits

- ✓ Automated scanning
 - ✓ Real-time vulnerability updates
 - ✓ Integration with AWS services (ECR, Lambda, Security Hub)
 - ✓ CVE-based vulnerability findings
 - ✓ Helps with compliance (PCI-DSS, CIS, etc.)
-



AWS Inspector – Core Components

Component	Description
Inspector Agent	Lightweight agent on EC2 to collect metadata (only needed for EC2 Classic Inspector)
Amazon Inspector Classic	The older version (deprecated)
Amazon Inspector (v2)	Current version (fully managed, agentless for ECR/Lambda)

Findings	Vulnerabilities and issues discovered during scans
Assessment Target	Resource (EC2, ECR, Lambda) being analyzed
Assessment Template	(Classic) Configuration for rules and duration

What Does It Scan?

Resource	What it Checks
EC2 Instances	CVEs, CIS benchmarks, OS patches
ECR Images	OS packages (e.g., Alpine, Ubuntu), libraries, CVEs
Lambda Functions	Software vulnerabilities in deployment packages

Features of AWS Inspector (New Version)

- Continuous scanning (not scheduled like Inspector Classic)
 - No manual configuration required
 - Uses **Systems Manager (SSM)** for EC2 (no agent needed if SSM is working)
 - Automatically scans new resources
 - Integrates with **AWS Organizations**
-